



BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Ordering Parts with PartStore™

Maintenance and Repair **Application** **Component Life Management** **Component Renewal (CRC)** **MARC Management**

Ordering Parts with PartStore™0

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1.0 Introduction

Many customers are automating their procurement processes and integrating with supplier systems to streamline their operations and reduce transaction costs. Since 2001, Caterpillar has been an industry leader in the integrated procurement of parts by facilitating hundreds of connections between customer business systems and their Cat® dealer's business systems. Customers who procure parts and receive electronic invoices through these connections experience transaction cost savings of as much as 50% or more, depending on their current processes. One customer's process assessment showed that over half of the customer's manual process steps were eliminated during the following processes:

- Ordering
- Shipping/Receiving
- Invoice Reconciliation
- Accounts Payable

2.0 Best Practice Description

The **PartStore™ IP Deployment Program** will enable a dealer's largest parts customers to automate their parts ordering process. There are two approaches to this automation: PartStore Web and PartStore IP.

"PartStore Web" is an internet application that is accessed through the dealer's web site that allows Customers to check for parts availability and pricing and place accurate parts orders on-line.

"PartStore IP" allows us to integrate our customers' enterprise systems with our Dealer's business system to enable the following transactions to be completed electronically: direct orders, stock orders, planned orders, order responses, pay-upon-receipt transactions, invoice updates and electronic funds transfers.

3.0 Implementation Steps

You have 2 options when it comes to connecting to PartStore: PartStore Web and PartStore Integrated Procurement

3.1 PartStore Web

To access PartStore Web, you must locate the Caterpillar Dealer's web site or Dealer StoreFront, register and log in successfully, and be granted access to PartStore Web. This section details the following topics:

- [Locate the Caterpillar Dealer's Web site or Dealer StoreFront](#)
- [Register at Dealer's web site](#)
- [Request PartStore Web Access](#)
- [Access PartStore Web](#)
- [Print Screens in PartStore Web](#)
- [Required Fields in PartStore Web](#)

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Locate the Dealer's Web Site or Dealer StoreFront

You can access to your Cat Dealer's web site in one of two ways: use the Dealer's URL or use the 'Dealer Locator' on the Caterpillar Inc. web site (<http://www.cat.com>).

The Dealer's URL or web address is found through communication with a representative of the Dealer, printed on an invoice from a previous purchase, or advertised inside or outside the dealership. Type the URL into the 'Address' box of a web browser and the Dealer web site is displayed.

To use the 'Dealer Locator' on the Caterpillar, Inc website:

- Open a web browser.

The browser window is displayed.

- In the 'Address' text box type: <http://www.cat.com>

The Caterpillar corporate web site is displayed in the browser window.

- In the main navigation, upper right, click 'Find a Dealer.'

The 'Find a Dealer' search screen is displayed.

- Enter the information for the dealer or location information and click 'Find.'

The search results are displayed.

- For a selected dealer, in the 'Links' column, if the link exists, click 'Go to Website.'

The specified dealer's web site is displayed in a new window.



NOTE: If your Cat dealership uses the Dealer StoreFront, its URL is in the format: 'http://dealer.cat.com/', where 'dealer' is replaced with a dealer specific word. For most dealers, 'dealer' is replaced with the name of the dealer.

If there is uncertainty about the URL, please contact your Caterpillar Dealer.

Register at Dealer's Web Site

As a new customer you must be registered at the dealer's web site or Dealer StoreFront in order to use PartStore Web. You must also request PartStore Web access.

Complete the following steps to register at the Dealer StoreFront:

- From the 'Dealer StoreFront Home' screen, click 'Join.' (Figure 1)

The 'Privacy Statement' screen is displayed. (Figure 2)

- At the bottom of the 'Privacy Statement' screen, click 'Accept.' (Figure 2)

The 'Registration/Profile Information' screen is displayed. (Figure 3)

- Complete the required fields of the 'Registration/Profile Information' screen.
- At the bottom of the 'Registration/Profile Information' screen click 'Submit.' (Figure 3)
- A message is displayed at the top of the 'Registration/Profile Information' screen that indicates registration is successful. The message is in green font. (Figure 4)

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NOTE: All fields marked with an asterisk are required.

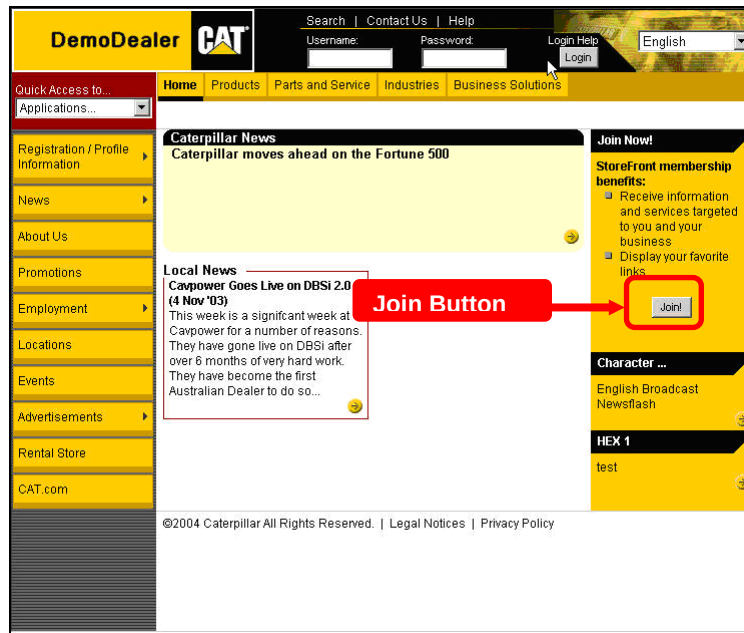


Figure 1: Dealer StoreFront Home Screen

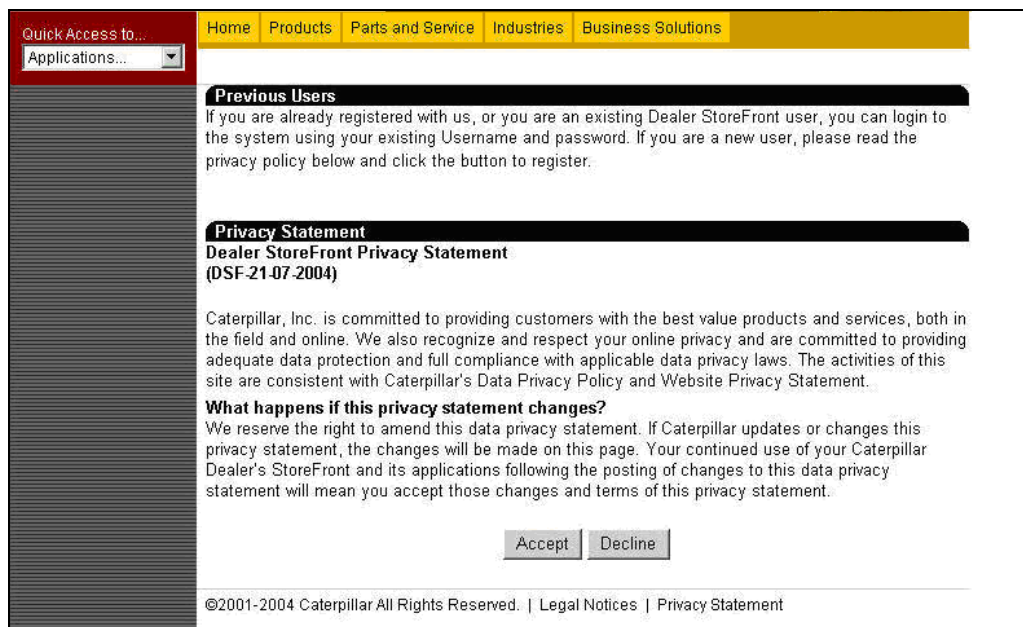


Figure 2 : Privacy Statement Screen

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Figure 3: Personal Information Screen

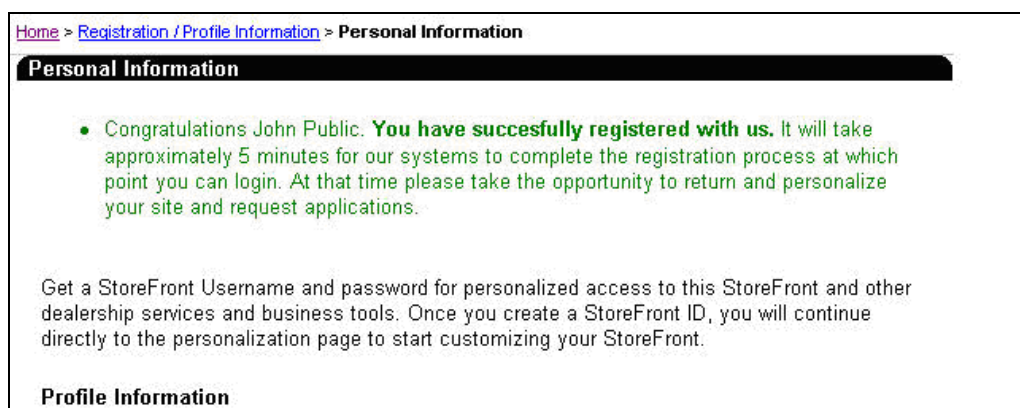


Figure 4 : Registration Successful Message

At this point, the dealer Site Administrator receives an email requesting a reply to your request (Figure 5). You receive a copy of the same email message.

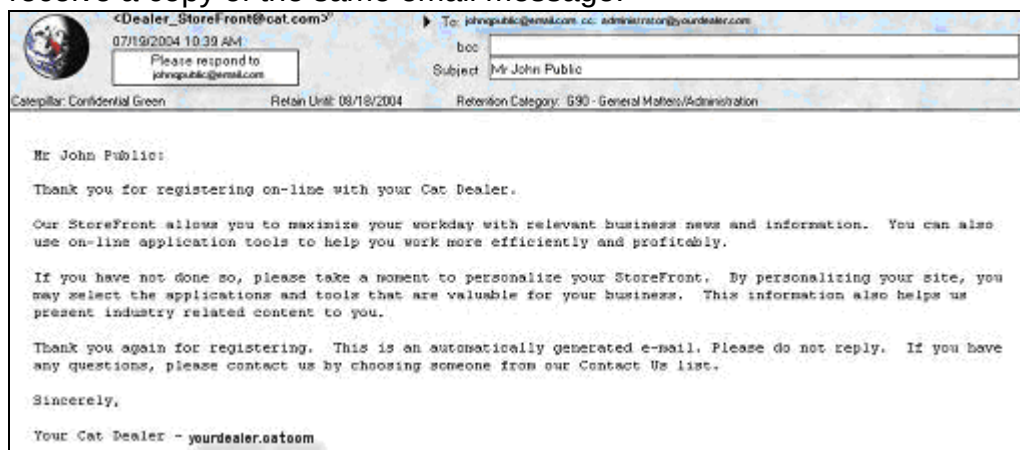


Figure 5: Customer Registration with Dealer StoreFront Email

Request PartStore Web Access

After you successfully register with Dealer StoreFront, you must request access to Dealer StoreFront applications, including PartStore Web.

Complete the following steps to request PartStore Web Access:

- From the Dealer StoreFront left navigation, click 'My Applications.'
The 'My Applications' screen is displayed. (Figure 6)
- From the 'My Applications' screen, select 'PartStore.'
- Click 'Submit Changes.'
- An e-mail is sent to your dealer requesting access to PartStore Web. Once the dealer gives your privileges to access PartStore Web, you will receive an e-mail or phone call.
Continue with '
- Access ' below.

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Figure 6 : My Applications Screen

Access PartStore Web

Once you locate the Dealer StoreFront, register and log in successfully, and granted access to PartStore Web, you can navigate from the Dealer StoreFront to PartStore Web in one of two ways:

- The 'Quick Access' dropdown menu. (Figure 7)
- The 'Parts and Service' tab. (Figure 8)

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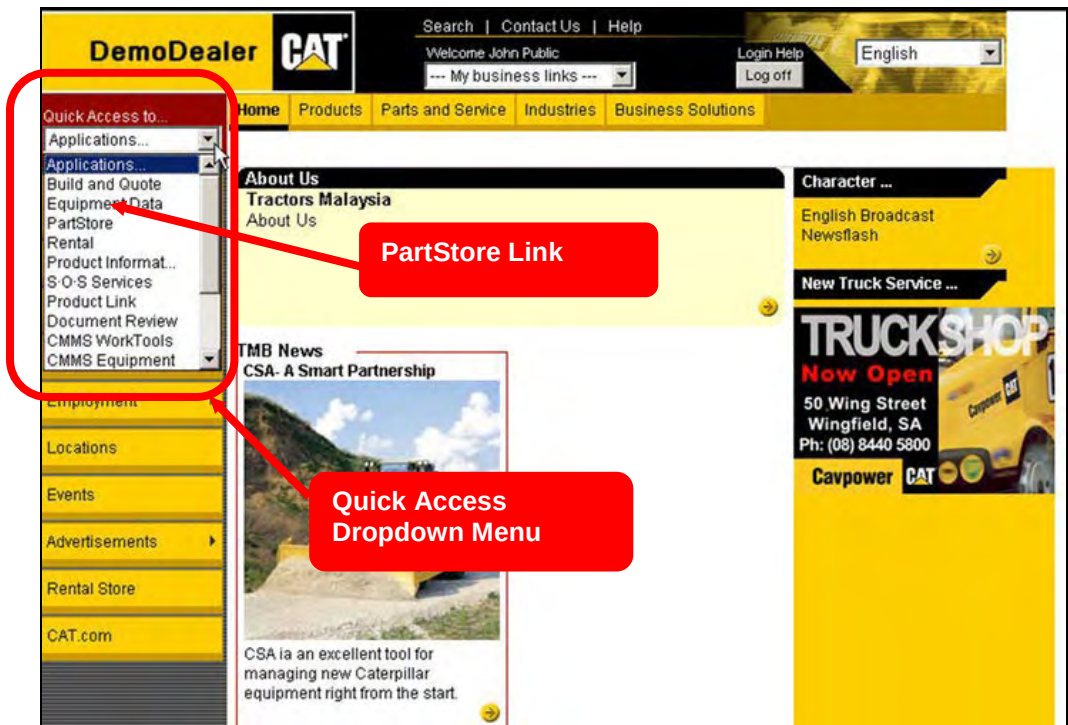


Figure 7 : Dealer StoreFront Quick Access Dropdown Menu

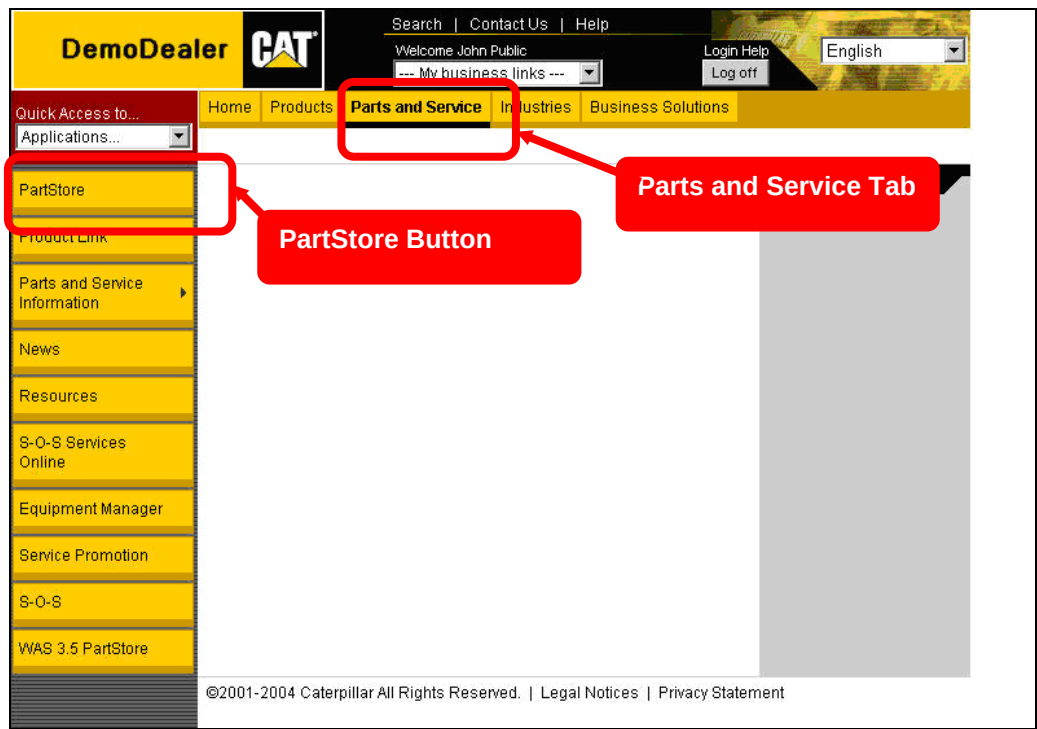


Figure 8 : Dealer StoreFront Parts and Service Screen

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Print Screens from PartStore Web

Most screens viewable in PartStore Web can be printed. If the print screen option is available on a screen it appears as a hyperlink titled: 'Print This Page' located to the right of the screen title.

The screenshot shows the 'Customer Information' screen in PartStore Web. At the top right, there are links for 'Preferences' and 'PartStore Home'. Below the title 'Customer Information', there is a 'Print This Page' link. A red box highlights this link, and a red callout bubble points to it with the text 'Print This Page Link'. The form contains fields for 'Ordered for:', 'Bill To:', 'Name:', 'Phone Number:', 'Email Address:', and 'Store Location:'. The 'Store Location' field has a dropdown menu set to 'Location 04'. At the bottom, there is an 'Order Entry' button.

Figure 9 : Print This Page Link

Required Fields in PartStore Web

In PartStore Web screens, any field marked with an asterisk (*) is required to continue to the next screen or proceed to the next step in the process.

3.2 PartStore Integrated Procurement (IP)

Connecting to PartStore Integrated Procurement is a much more involved process. The customer should first contact the dealer and request a project be started to connect PartStore Integrated Procurement is quite flexible, and has only two key requirements: Be able to send data via XML, and that data must be sent via a HTTPS secure post. See attached White Paper for more details on implementing an IP connection.

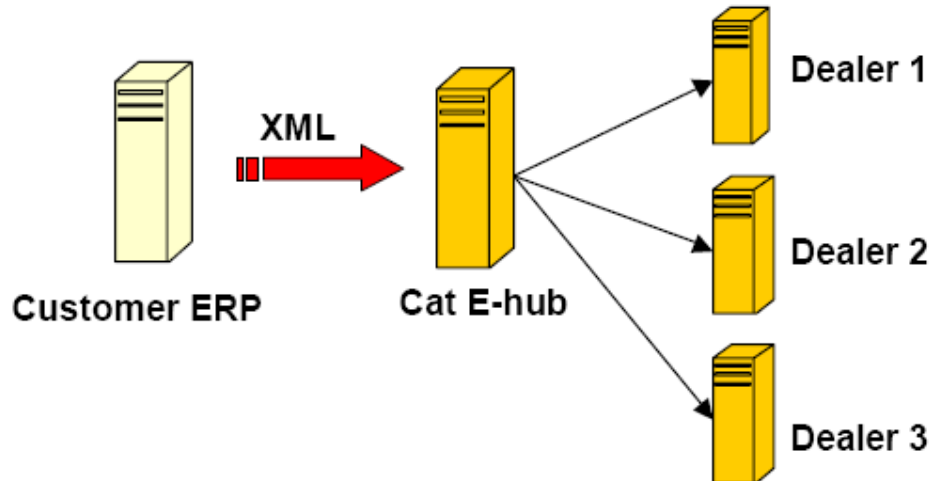
PartStore Integrated Procurement can be customized based on the customer's needs. Business rules are set at the PartStore eHub level, which can be set around:

- Backordered parts
- Price discrepancies
- Invalid Part numbers
- Replaced Parts
- Virtually any other customized need the customer may have

There are 2 main integration options available to the customer who wishes to use PartStore Integrated Procurement: Direct or via third party.

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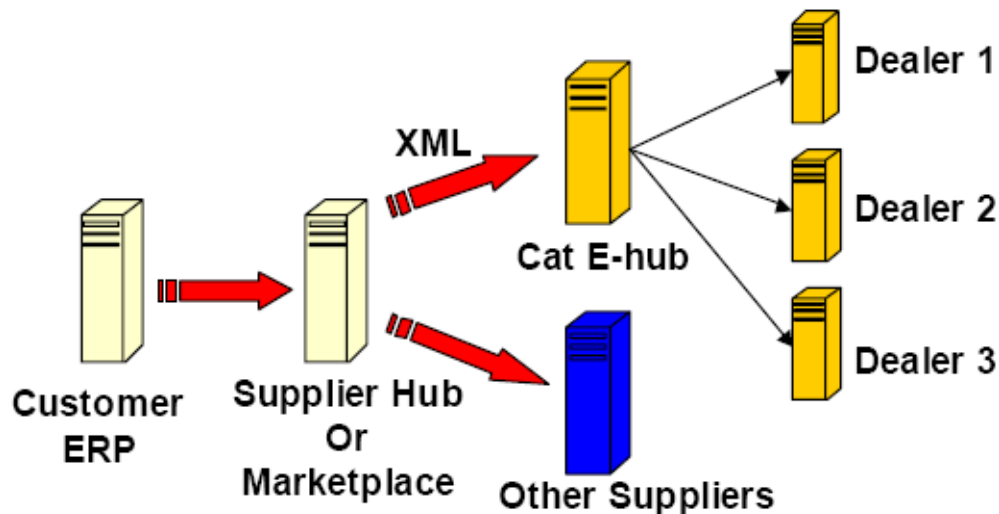
Direct Connection



Advantages with Direct Connection to the Caterpillar E-hub

- High availability, currently over 99%, due to a single connection point
- No transaction fees to a third party
- All Caterpillar e-hub services and connections are available without waiting for a third party to provide this access
- Management is potentially easier with two parties instead of three

Third Party Connection



Advantages with Connection through a Vendor Hub or Marketplace Partner

- Customer can utilize the same technical connection for multiple suppliers
- Less reliance on the customer's IS department to establish and maintain the connection
- Agreements can include other services or even full hardware and services outsourcing.

Note: In the majority of cases if an organization is capable of connecting to a vendor hub or marketplace partner they will also be capable of a direct connection.

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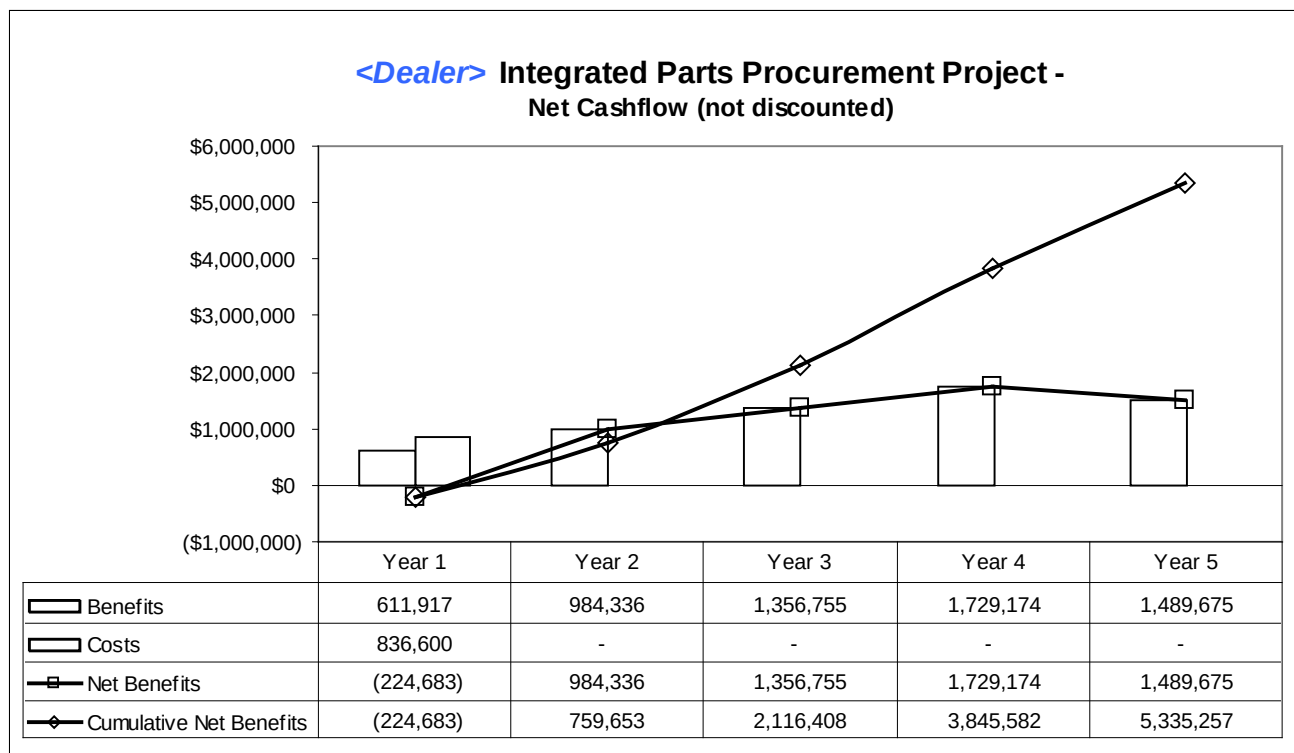
4.0 Benefits

Automating the parts ordering process creates benefits for both our customers and for the dealer. For our customers, the benefits include:

- Improved parts availability and reduced equipment down-time due to instant availability on emergency orders, reduced order-delivery times, and improved order accuracy; and
- Reduced internal costs through automation of stock replenishment transactions, elimination of manual steps and duplicate data entry in all transactions, and reduced invoiced discrepancies.

For the dealer, the benefits include:

- Increased customer satisfaction & loyalty, with the potential for increased market share and sales;
- Reduced transaction costs through the elimination of manual steps and duplicate data entry, fewer returned spare parts, and reduced invoice discrepancies;
- Faster payment through automation of invoicing and payments; and
- Migration of our eBusiness activity to the most cost-effective platform (Cat eHub, Seamless migration to future releases of Cat's DBSi).



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5.0 Resources Required

For connecting to PartStore Web, the buyer is typically the only one needed to get access. For PartStore IP projects, it is a bit more involved. Typically, weekly conference calls are required to keep the project moving. As part of the project, the following people should be involved:

- Caterpillar Project Leader (can be requested via eparts@cat.com)
- Caterpillar PartStore Developer
- Dealer PartStore Admin
- Dealer PartStore sales rep/manager (optional)
- Customer Procurement manager
- Customer Buyer
- Customer IT representative
- 3rd Party representative (optional)

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

Cat PartStore IP White Paper V5.pdf

7.0 Related Best Practices

8.0 Acknowledgements

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